

06 — EMOTIONAL CONNECTION

MASTER_CORE v2.4 Knowledge Base. Research-informed reference material; not a universal rulebook. SYNTHETIC examples are illustrative. Future private REAL_CASE data must be labeled separately and must not be fabricated.

Core model

- Connection is not created by forcing vulnerability.
- Relevant self-disclosure plus perceived responsiveness can support closeness, but effects depend on context.

Depth ladder

- 1 — FACTUAL: what happened.
- 2 — PREFERENCE: what they like/think.
- 3 — EXPERIENCE: a personal story.
- 4 — EMOTION/MEANING: why it mattered.
- 5 — VULNERABILITY: deeper material; use only when context supports it.

Response moves

- NOTICE → identify meaningful part.
- VALIDATE → acknowledge it accurately.
- RELATE → share a proportionate related detail.
- EXPLORE → ask one useful question only when appropriate.
- PAUSE → allow space when the person appears low-energy.

Important caution

- Do not turn every emotional message into a therapy-style interview.
- Online disclosure has context-dependent effects; deeper disclosure is not automatically better.

Retrieval tags

- EMOTIONAL / DISCLOSURE / RESPONSIVENESS / VALIDATE / VULNERABILITY / CLOSENESS / APPROPRIATENESS

WEB / RESEARCH SOURCE NOTES

Research on self-disclosure / appropriateness: Supports treating disclosure depth, narrativity, frequency and perceived appropriateness as contextual variables rather than fixed rules.

<https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC5348110/>

Research on online disclosure: Shows online disclosure effects differ by context and that nonresponse online can have multiple causes; supports avoiding simplistic interpretations.

<https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC6398828/>

Partner responsiveness and closeness: Supports the relevance of emotional disclosure and perceived responsiveness to closeness/relationship adjustment.

<https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC7381078/>

Hybrid RAG architecture: Example of BM25 + dense retrieval + reranking + LLM evaluation; used here only as architecture inspiration, not as dating advice.

<https://github.com/tim-ponomarev/hybrid-rag>

Hybrid RAG project: Example of document-type-aware hybrid retrieval using dense and sparse search.

<https://github.com/gwyer/hybrid-rag-project>